Shivangi Ambardar

Department of Economics, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign
sambar3@illinois.edu · 608-346-5404 · shivangiambardar.com

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign *Expected 2027*
Dissertation Committee: Dan Bernhardt (Co-Chair), Lena Song (Co-Chair), Alexander Bartik, Jorge Lemus.

M.S. in Economics, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign *2024*

B.A. in Quantitative Economics & Mathematics, Beloit College *2021*
Full Tuition Scholarship ($200,000); Dean's List (8 semesters).

RESEARCH FIELDS

Economics of Technological Change, Media Economics, Economic History.

RESEARCH

- "Selective Technological Disruption: Evidence from TV Entry and Radio Stations" (Job Market Paper)
  I study how U.S. radio stations responded to the arrival of television, using newly collected FCC financial records and differences in when markets got television because of the FCC's 1948–1952 freeze. Television reduced network revenue by 31.5 percent and increased local advertising revenue by 12.5 percent, with no significant change in total revenue.
- "Spatial Diffusion of Unions: Historical Evidence from the UK" (with Keitaro Ninomiya)
  We study whether workplace accidents encouraged workers to organize and whether unionization spread between workplaces connected by railway lines, using newly digitized records of accidents and railway union activity.
- "Special Economic Zones and Local Economic Development in India"
  I study whether relatively small special economic zones promote local development, using village-level nighttime lights and census data on firms and employment. Nighttime lights rise most strongly within 5 km of a zone, alongside higher manufacturing employment and firm counts in nearby villages.

WORK IN PROGRESS

- "Pricing the Airwaves: Television Entry and Radio Advertising Rates"
- "Market Size, Competition, and Television Entry: Evidence from the FCC Freeze"
- "When Unionized Workers Arrive: Employer Responses and Workplace Outcomes" (with Keitaro Ninomiya)

RESEARCH AND PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign *2024–Present*
- Built firm-level panel datasets (~29,000 observations) from unstructured historical financial reports using automated Python pipelines (Azure Document Intelligence, LLM APIs), cutting manual processing by over 80%.
- Ran relevant econometric analyses in Stata (DiD, IV, panel regressions).
- Led three undergraduate research assistants across project workstreams, including digitizing new data and running validation checks on raw data.

Economist / Consultant, New York State Attorney General's Office *2025*
- Contributed to the economic analysis behind the New York Attorney General's SAFE for Kids Act rules on algorithmic feeds for minors.
- Conducted a cost-benefit analysis, synthesizing academic literature, to estimate the costs to the six largest social media firms and the benefits to minors.

Data Analytics Intern, PepsiCo, Consumer Insights *2023*
- Modeled consumer purchasing patterns and built market-share forecasts across a national salty snack portfolio.
- Estimated demand elasticities for PepsiCo and rival product lines to identify pricing opportunities and risks.
- Maintained analytical databases and produced executive-ready reports on market trends and strategic implications.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign *2022–Present*

- Head Teaching Assistant, Principles of Microeconomics (ECON 102) — Fall 2023–Present
- Teaching Assistant, Principles of Microeconomics (ECON 102) — Spring 2023 (head TA in training)
- Assistant Instructor, Microeconomic Theory (ECON 500), M.S. in Policy Economics (MSPE) — Fall 2022

Named to the List of Teachers Ranked as Excellent (6 semesters).[1]

Beloit College *2018–2021*

Teaching Assistant; managed office hours for the following courses:

- Principles of Economics — SP2020 (2 sections), FA2019, SP2019, FA2018, SP2018
- Economic Theory: Microeconomics — SP2020, FA2019, SP2019
- Seminar: Energy and Environmental Economics — SP2020, FA2020
- Quantitative Methods — FA2019, FA2020, SP2021
- Game Theory — FA2019
- Sustainable Agricultural Management — SP2019

AWARDS

1. Robert E. Demarest Memorial Teaching Award ($5,000) *2025, University of Illinois*
2. Morris & Sally Kleiner Labor Economics Prize ($3,000) *2023, University of Illinois*
3. Albert R. Topps Economics Award *2021, Beloit College*
4. McAllister Award *2019, Beloit College*
5. Alexander Award *2018, Beloit College*
6. Full Tuition Scholarship ($200,000); Dean's List (8 semesters) *2017–2021, Beloit College*

PRESENTATIONS

1. Applied Microeconomics Research Seminar, University of Illinois (8 presentations).
2. "AI-Assisted Digitization of Archival Records," lightning talk, University of Illinois workshop (2026).

SERVICE AND LEADERSHIP

Secretary, Illini Glider Club. FAA private glider pilot certificate (in progress).
Member, Students Advising on Graduate Education (SAGE), University of Illinois (2026).
Reviewer, Midwest International Economic Development Conference (2025).

REFERENCES

Dan Bernhardt (Co-Chair)
IBE Distinguished Professor of Economics
University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign
danber@illinois.edu

Lena Song (Co-Chair)
Assistant Professor of Economics
University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign
lenasong@illinois.edu

Alexander Bartik
Assistant Professor of Economics
University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign
abartik@illinois.edu

Jorge Lemus
Associate Professor of Economics
University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign
jalemus@illinois.edu

[1]The University of Illinois has since discontinued the List of Teachers Ranked as Excellent; the recognition was received in every eligible semester it was offered.